

LOUISIANA OWNER-BUILDER PERMIT KIT

Sign the right affidavit · File with the right office · Pass the inspections

Project Address: _____

City / Town: _____

Parish: _____

Permit Office: _____

Owner-Builder: _____

Permit Application Date: _____

Your permit office may be the parish or the town — LA.4 shows you how to tell.

Every Louisiana statute, threshold, and requirement in this kit
is cited on the page it appears on — verified September 2026.

BUILD YOUR HOUSE

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First Edition — 2026

How to Use This Kit

Five working documents, from the affidavit that gets you the permit to the certificate of occupancy your lender has to file.

Louisiana gives an owner-builder something most states do not: a named statutory exemption that lets you **hire and direct subcontractors** on your own house without a contractor license. It is not a loophole and it is not local practice — the Legislature wrote it down, and it wrote down the affidavit that proves you are entitled to it.

It also gives you a mandatory statewide code that **no parish is allowed to opt out of**. There is no Louisiana equivalent of the rural county where nobody inspects. Every parish must enforce, and where a parish is too small to staff a counter, the law names the workaround and gives it to you by name.

The problem is that almost everything written about building in Louisiana is out of date. The exemption statute everyone cites was **repealed in 2022**. The licensing threshold everyone quotes was changed. The construction-code chapter was **renumbered into a different Title** of the Revised Statutes, and the agency that runs it was renamed. This kit was rebuilt from the current text in September 2026, and every page shows you where to check it yourself.

WHAT IS IN THE KIT

The five documents

	Document	What it does for you
LA.1	Owner-Builder Exemption Walkthrough	The exemption that actually exists, the one that was repealed, the affidavit and who receives it, and the trade-by-trade answer on what you may do yourself. Read this first.
LA.2	Permit Application Checklist	What to gather before you file — the affidavit, the sewage permit, the code editions in force, the flood and wind questions, and the deadline that decides which code you build to.
LA.3	Inspection Sequence	The order inspections happen in, the private-inspector route the statute gives you by name, and fields for dates and results.
LA.4	Where to File Directory	Parish or town — how to settle which one, how to find the licensed inspector who already covers your parish, and a page to write down every office you confirmed.
LA.5	Forms & Documents Index	Each document you will meet: what it is, when, and from where.

HOW TO USE IT

- **Start with LA.1.** The affidavit of exemption is a precondition to your building permit, not a form you file afterwards. Knowing which statute it comes from is what stops a counter clerk handing you the wrong one.
- **Settle parish or town before anything else.** The parish building official covers only the unincorporated area. A city mailing address is not the same as being inside the city limits, and filing in the wrong place costs weeks. LA.4 walks it.
- **Start the sewage permit early** if you are not on public sewer. It is a two-stage state permit and the first stage has to be approved before you may install anything.
- **Watch the code date in LA.2.** Louisiana pins your house to the codes in force on the day you applied for your original building permit — which makes your application date a design decision, not paperwork.
- **Keep LA.3 on the job** and record every inspection as it happens, with the name of the inspector and their license number.

How these facts were checked — and what this is not

Every Louisiana claim here was read against its primary source in September 2026 — the Revised Statutes at legis.la.gov, the Louisiana Administrative Code at doa.la.gov, and the Louisiana Uniform Construction Code Commission's own compiled law-and-rules volume — and is cited where it appears. Where the answer genuinely depends on your parish or your town, the kit says so and gives you a line to write what you confirmed. Not legal advice.